

The Coca-Cola Company

1Q24 First Impressions

KO just reported 1Q24 Comparable EPS of \$0.72 that compares to Consensus of \$0.70 and Barclays Research \$0.69. Upside was driven by stronger gross margins than we had estimated.

Our Thoughts

KO posted a solid quarter with better than expected Unit Case Volume, +1%. We'd expected both concentrate sales & UCV to be down LSD given timing dynamics, so this was a positive surprise. To be sure, hyperinflationary pricing is playing a significant role, driving the majority of the OSG beat in the quarter and the upside to the full-year guidance, but operating margins also came in better than expected in 1Q, resulting in a 2-3c EPS beat. Unit case volumes and concentrate sales notably were well ahead of our estimates in Latin America, despite the inflationary pricing (e.g. UCV came in fully 11 points ahead of our forecast) and we'd also call out the flat volume metrics in North America where we had been forecasting modest declines. We'll look for more color on the call as to the margin bridge, vis-à-vis benefits from refranchising vs operating leverage/mix. Here, we'd note that North America operating margins were up another 100bps, a region where there is no refranchising at play.

Highlights

- Organic sales +11% vs. our +4.5%, with the beat again fully driven by price/mix (+13% vs. our +6.5%) that we mainly attribute to hyperinflationary markets
- All geographic units, including North America, outperformed our expectations (ex. Global Ventures)
- Unit case volumes +1% vs. our -1%; concentrate sales in-line at -2%
- Gross margins +135 bps vs. our +25 bps, with strong reinvestment (absolute SG&A ~5.5% higher than our forecast) translating to +60 bps of operating margin expansion (vs. our flat)

Lowlights

- Sports drinks -3% as a decline in North America more than offset growth elsewhere, driven by a BodyArmor drag
- Asia Pacific concentrate sales and UCVs lagged our model by a respective 2 and 4 points, driven by a broader slowdown in China YoY

2024 Guidance

- Updated:
 - Organic revenue +8-9% (from +6-7% & vs. our +6.7% & Consensus +6.9%)
 - FX headwind of 4-5% on net revenues (from ~2-3% & vs. our -2.8% and Consensus -2.9%) & 7-8% drag on comparable EPS (from 4-5%)
 - Comparable constant currency EPS +11-13% (from +8-10%)
 - Effective tax rate 19.0% (from 19.2%), not including impact of ongoing tax litigation

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| CORE

KO	OVERWEIGHT
U.S. CHPC & Beverages	NEUTRAL
Price Target	USD 68.00
Price (29-Apr-24)	USD 62.04
Potential Upside/Downside	+9.6%

U.S. CHPC & Beverages

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BCI, US

- Maintained:
- Comparable EPS +4-5% that implies \$2.79-\$2.82 (vs. our and Consensus \$2.81)
 - Structural headwind of ~4-5% on net revenues and a ~2% drag on comparable EPS
- All cash flow & capex metrics

2Q24 Guidance

- Net revenue headwinds: FX ~6% (our -3.3%); structural ~5-6% (our -4.8%) on net revenues and ~8-9% on comparable EPS
- Comparable EPS headwinds: FX ~5-6%; structural ~2%

KO 1Q24 Earnings Call Details:

Today @ 8:30 AM ET - U.S. Dial: 1-888-415-4465; International: 1-646-960-0140; Passcode: 6819315.

Analyst(s) Certification(s):

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The Coca-Cola Company (KO, 29-Apr-2024, USD 62.04), Overweight/Neutral, CD/CE/D/E/J/K/L/M/N

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U.S. CHPC & Beverages

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Constellation Brands (STZ)	Coty Inc. (COTY)	Duckhorn Portfolio Inc (NAPA)
Edgewell Personal Care Company (EPC)	Energizer Holdings, Inc (ENR)	International Flavors & Fragrances (IFF)
Keurig Dr Pepper (KDP)	Kimberly-Clark Corp. (KMB)	Molson Coors Beverage Company (TAP)

Newell Brands Inc. (NWL)	ODDITY Tech Ltd. (ODD)	Olaplex Holdings, Inc. (OLPX)
PepsiCo Inc. (PEP)	Procter & Gamble (PG)	Reynolds Consumer Products (REYN)
The Coca-Cola Company (KO)	The Estée Lauder Companies (EL)	

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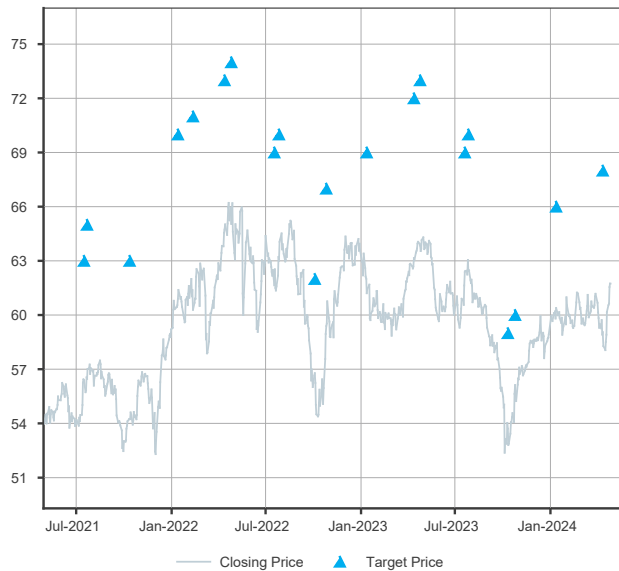
Stock Rating: **OVERWEIGHT**

Industry View: **NEUTRAL**

Closing Price: **USD 62.04** (29-Apr-2024)

Rating and Price Target Chart - USD (as of 29-Apr-2024)

Currency=USD



Source: IDC, Barclays Research

[Link to Barclays Live for interactive charting](#)

Publication Date	Closing Price*	Rating	Adjusted Price Target
11-Apr-2024	59.72		68.00
12-Jan-2024	59.81		66.00
25-Oct-2023	55.64		60.00
11-Oct-2023	54.03		59.00
27-Jul-2023	63.05		70.00
20-Jul-2023	61.64		69.00
25-Apr-2023	63.95		73.00
13-Apr-2023	62.69		72.00
12-Jan-2023	61.21		69.00
26-Oct-2022	58.95		67.00
04-Oct-2022	56.78		62.00
27-Jul-2022	63.21		70.00
18-Jul-2022	61.65		69.00
26-Apr-2022	65.94		74.00
13-Apr-2022	64.73		73.00
11-Feb-2022	61.38		71.00
13-Jan-2022	60.90		70.00
12-Oct-2021	54.23		63.00
22-Jul-2021	56.47		65.00
16-Jul-2021	56.40		63.00

On 30-Apr-2021, prior to any intra-day change that may have been published, the rating for this security was Overweight, and the adjusted price target was 62.00.

Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research

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Valuation Methodology: Our price target of \$68 is based on a ~24.1x P/E reflecting a +20% premium to Large-Cap Staples peers on our CY24 EPS estimate of \$2.81.

Risks which May Impede the Achievement of the Barclays Research Valuation and Price Target: 1) FX headwinds force downward revision of estimates, 2) Slowdown in CSD category growth, 3) More sugar taxes cloud the dialogue, 4) Deterioration in North American pricing environment would hurt results

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